

Title: Qroo Paul – Subjunctive Trigger Worksheet Review – Lydia’s Notes

(Lydia Brandt, posted 1st revd date: 3/18/2025; © 2025 All Rights Reserved)

Video & Worksheet: <https://www.skool.com/qroo/subjunctive-trigger-worksheet-review?p=4c879f3d>

Classroom, Intermediate / Advanced Lessons, “Subjunctive Exercise”

There are website links within this document. Click on them or copy & paste into your browser.

ABBREVIATIONS

n	footnote
sent.	sentence
Básica	Real Academia Española, Nueva gramática Básica de la lengua Española (mayo 2023 ed.)
Moutoux	Drawing Sentences (2016), https://www.german-latin-english.com/
O’Brien	Sentence Diagramming Reference Manual (2019)
GR	O’Brien, Grammar Revolution https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/
NRGMS	Butt, Benjamin, Rodríguez, A New Reference Grammar of Modern Spanish (6 th ed. 2019) NRGMS, sec. ___, p. ___ [section name]
Tu Mundo	Andrade, Puche, Egasse, Muñoz, (2nd ed. 2019) Tu Mundo sec. ___ p. ___
Vistas	Blanco, Donley, Vistas (4 th ed. 2012), p. ___

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SUMMARY: Complex Sentences

Independent Clause

3 Types of Dependent Clauses



“**subject**”= who or what the sentence is about.

“**verb**” = what the subject is or does.
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Lesson 1

Subject + **verb in main clause expresses:**
habitual action

future action
future action
future action
future action
future action

ALWAYS Subjunctive
ALWAYS Subjunctive
ALWAYS Subjunctive

ADVERB CLAUSE

Subordinating
Conjunction
cuando

cuando
en cuanto
hasta que
después de que
tan pronto como

en caso de que
a menos que
antes (de) que

ADVERB CLAUSE (Subject + verb)
modifies the verb in the main clause)
(Indicative verb) sent. 1, 5, 12, 20

(Subjunctive verb) sent. 18, 27, 30
(Subjunctive verb) sent. 15
(Subjunctive verb) sent. 2, 6, 23
(Subjunctive verb) sent. 13
(Subjunctive verb) sent. 22

(ALWAYS Subjunctive verb) sent. 28
(ALWAYS Subjunctive verb) sent. 7
(ALWAYS Subjunctive verb) sent. 25

See Sentence Diagram Adverb Clause, p.9

ADJECTIVE CLAUSE

Subject + verb
The person, place, thing, idea
in the Main Clause is:

Relative Pronoun
OR a Relative Adverb
(see p. 11 for a list)

ADJECTIVE CLAUSE (Subject + verb)
modifies antecedent in main clause

NOT specific, INdefinite person, thing, idea
¿Conoces a alguien (someone)

que

(Subjunctive verb)
sent. 29 alguien indefinite pronoun
sent. 9, 21 un(a) indefinite article

Specific, definite person, thing, idea
clearly known, certain, or definite

que

(Indicative verb)
sent. 10 I know a person

See Sentence Diagram Adjective Clause, p.13

NOTE: Words can act as more than 1 part of speech. Here “**que**” acts a relative pronoun. In the Noun Clause section below, “que” acts as a subordinating conjunction to connect the main and dependent clauses.

NOUN CLAUSE

WEIRDO verbs

que (conjunction)
that (conjunction)

NOUN CLAUSE (Subject + verb)
(acts as a noun & does noun jobs.)

Emotion (**me molesta; me preocupa,**
me sorprende)

que

SUBJECT - NOUN CLAUSE
(Subjunctive verb) sent. 14, 16, 24

Doubt (**don't believe, don't think**)

que

DIRECT OBJECT - NOUN CLAUSE
(Subjunctive verb) sent. 3,19

Compare **CERTAINTY, BELIEF, NO DOUBT**

Es cierto, Creo que, No dudo,
No hay duda, No cabe duda

que

(Indicative verb) sent. 4, 8, 11, 17,26

See Sentence Diagram Noun Clause, p.16-17

THE 1st STEP IN MY ANALYSIS was to learn what a clause is and how it becomes a complex sentence.

TEXT GRAMMAR SOURCES (begins):

QROO SPANISH CREW Paul Kurtzweil, “Subjunctive Trigger Worksheet Review”

INTRODUCTION: The Spanish subjunctive has always baffled me. I could never figure out the answer to a simple question: **What am I looking at?** Yes, on the surface I see 30 sentences in a worksheet titled: “Subjunctive or Indicative” – but “What I am looking at? This question remained even after 1½ years of Spanish courses in past years! Then, all of a sudden, (after LOTSA hours of research), the answer!

I am looking at a complex sentence.

“What is a complex sentence?

A complex sentence communicates more than one idea.

- One part (the main clause) is like a simple sentence: it can stand on its own: [subject + verb = a complete thought].
- The other part (the [dependent] clause) gives more detail about the simple sentence, but it cannot stand alone [even though it too has a subject + verb].”

“[L]ook at this sentence: [I always go out to greet my dad when he arrives.]

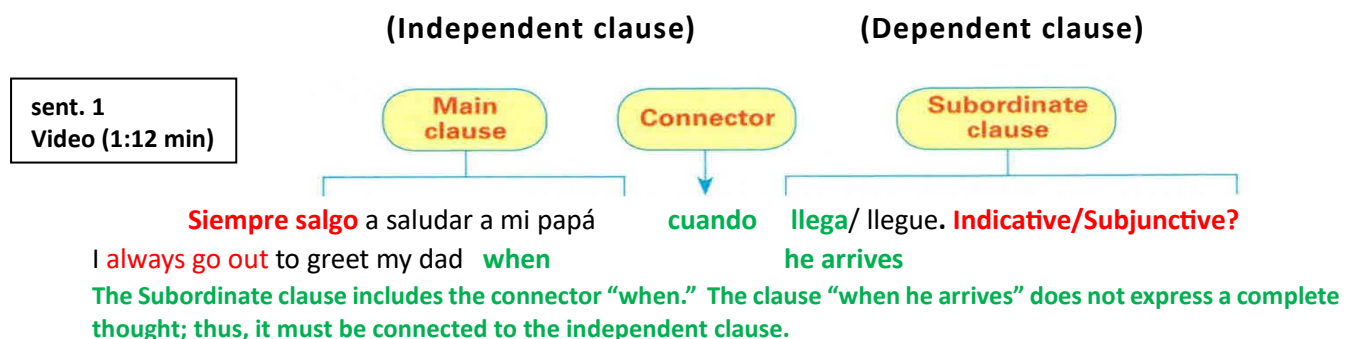
- The main clause is **[I always go out to greet my dad]**. It has a subject (I) and a verb (go out) and makes sense by itself.
- The [dependent] clause is **['When he arrived']**. Although it is a clause with a subject (he) and a verb (arrives), it doesn't make sense on its own. [We have to glue the connector (when) to the main clause for it to make sense. In Spanish, the connector may cause the verb in the dependent clause to change its “mood” from indicative to subjunctive.]”

“[Why go through all the trouble of learning about a complex sentence?] “If you're learning a new language, understanding sentence structure is crucial! Different languages have different structures, and grasping these differences aids in language acquisition.”
<https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/sentence-structure.html> “Complex sentences add extra detail and information to create a vivid picture in the reader’s mind. Complex sentences ... show cause and effect, contrast, condition, or concession...and combin[e] related ideas into one sentence [to] avoid[] redundancy.” <https://www.bbc.co.uk/bitesize/articles/zbdxwnb#>:

With that down, I watched Paul’s video again (and again ...), and ruthlessly dissected the complex sentences – all 30 of them -- to learn how the subjunctive worked in the various clauses. Lydia’s Notes capture what I learned in my research and analysis of the Worksheet.

WHAT IS A CLAUSE? - “A clause is a part of a [complex] sentence that has its own verb and subject.” Tu Mundo, sec.15.2, pp. 536-537. “Clauses can be independent or dependent. Independent clauses can stand alone as complete thoughts. Dependent clauses [also called subordinate clauses] cannot stand alone because they don’t express complete thoughts and must be connected to independent clauses.” <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/clauses.html>

- **“Main clause. A main clause is somewhat similar to an independent clause¹:** It expresses a complete thought [and contains a subject and a verb.] Normally it could stand alone, but there’s a [subordinating conjunction](#) or [relative pronoun](#) attaching it to a subordinate clause.” <https://www.lawlessspanish.com/grammar/clauses/>
- **“Subordinate clause [also called a dependent clause].** A subordinate clause begins with a subordinating conjunction, a relative pronoun or adverb, or a noun marker [and contains a subject and a verb], that attaches it to a main clause.” All of the words come together to act as one part of speech:² an adjective, adverb, or noun. **We can divide these clauses into three categories based on what part of speech they function as:** an adjective clause, an adverb clause, or a noun clause.” <https://www.lawlessspanish.com/grammar/clauses/>



¹ **“Independent Clauses *Cláusulas independientes*.** An independent clause is a complete sentence that can stand alone or is attached to another independent clause with a [coordinating conjunction](#)..” <https://www.lawlessspanish.com/grammar/clauses/>

² English grammar and Spanish grammar are similar, but not identical. English has 8 **parts-of-speech**. [NOTE: In English, “the” and “a” are articles, but are the part-of-speech called “adjectives,” and NOT a separate 9th category “article” -- although you will see some websites referring to them as a 9th English part of speech.

In contrast, in Spanish, “the” [el, la, los, las] and “a” [un, una, unos, unas] are “articles.” In Spanish, “articles,” “possessives,” “quantifiers,” and “demonstratives” fall into the Spanish 9th part-of-speech, “determiners.” The other 8 parts of speech in Spanish are the same as in English. See *Básica de la lengua Española* at 6-7.

English: <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/parts-of-speech.html>

Spanish: <https://www.tellmeinspanish.com/grammar/parts-of-speech-in-spanish/> **NOTE: Words can act as more than 1 part of speech. With Adjective Clauses “que” acts as a relative pronoun to connect the main and dependent clauses. With Noun Clauses “que” acts as a subordinating conjunction.**

THE 2nd STEP IN MY ANALYSIS was to look at the sentences in Paul's worksheet. I began by identifying & grouping sentences by the type of clause: adverb, adjective, and noun clause. See Summary p. 2 for the groups I came up with.

Why do all this work? Because It shows that the connectors & subjunctive triggers differ depending on the type of clause.

THREE (3) TYPES OF DEPENDENT CLAUSES

Dependent clauses are divided into three categories based on what part of speech they function as:

As I looked at the Worksheet, could I identify the type of dependent clause in each sentence? What connector did the sentence use? What kind of connector was it? Subordinating conjunction? Relative Pronoun? And why did it matter?

COMPLEX SENTENCES

Independent Clause

3 Types of Dependent Clauses

Main
clause

Connector

Subordinate
clause

subject + verb

Subordinating
Conjunctions
(includes *Adverbs of Time*)

ADVERB CLAUSE

(connector + subject + verb)
(modifies the verb in the main clause)

subject + verb

Relative Pronoun
OR a Relative Adverb

ADJECTIVE CLAUSE

(connector + subject + verb)
(modifies antecedent (nouns & pronouns) in main clause)

subject + verb

(conjunction) que

NOUN CLAUSE

(connector + subject + verb)
(acts as a noun, and does noun jobs
(usually as a subject or direct object)

"**subject**" =
who or what
the sentence
is about.

"**verb**" = what
the subject is
or does.
Grammar
Revolution
Classroom,
Lesson 1

"A **complex sentence** is a sentence that contains an independent (main) clause and at least one dependent (subordinate) clause." Each of the three above, creates a complex sentence. <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/complex-sentence.html>

THE 3rd STEP IN MY ANALYSIS was to research each type of dependent clause AND (because I am a visual learner):

- I listed the connectors for each type of clause (Wow! different types for each clause),
- I listed the reason for choosing Subjective/Indicative, and finally
- I created visuals of the clauses & connectors. See p. 9, 13, 16-17

NOTE: The SENTENCE DIAGRAMS show how the dependent clause relates to the main clause. Adverb clauses modify verbs in the main clause. Adjective clauses modify nouns in the main clause. Noun clauses do noun jobs, often acting as direct objects in the main clause, but also as subjects.

NOTE: SENTENCE DIAGRAMS - In creating the Sentence Diagrams, I consulted Eugene Moutoux, *Drawing Sentences* (2016), and his website, Moutoux, <https://www.german-latin-english.com/> Mr. Moutoux is retired. I also consulted Elizabeth O'Brien's *Grammar Revolution* written materials and website. Sentence Diagramming Reference Manual (2019). <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/english-grammar-exercise.html> Lastly, I consulted *LanguaTalk*. The AI referenced several books for Spanish grammar, but stated there is no Spanish counterpart to *Drawing Sentences*. AI added: "If you want to **diagram sentences in Spanish** (similar to how Moutoux does for English), you can adapt the English diagramming method to Spanish sentences. The principles of sentence diagramming can be applied to Spanish grammar, even though the sentence structure differs slightly. I do know about diagramming sentences in English! Sentence diagramming is a way to visually break down the structure of a sentence to show the relationships between words, clauses, and phrases. If you're asking about how to apply this to Spanish sentences, or how to compare it to English diagramming, I'd be happy to help!"

ADVERB CLAUSE (OVERVIEW): "[A]n adverb is one of the parts of speech [in English & Spanish], and it modifies verbs, adjectives, and other adverbs. Adverbs help us determine where, when, how, how long, and how often things happen. ... [An adverb clause] is a group of two or more words that functions as an adverb. This group of words works as a single unit and indicates when, why, or in what way an action happens."

<https://www.spanish.academy/blog/all-about-adverbial-clauses-in-spanish/>

1. **CONNECTOR (Subordinate Conjunction/Indicative or Subjunctive):** "An adverb clause can be introduced by a subordinate conjunction, such as **cuando** (when). The verb in the dependent clause can be in the **subjunctive or the indicative** mood."
2. **CONNECTOR (Subordinate Conjunction/ALWAYS subjunctive):** "An adverb clause **also** can be introduced by a subordinate conjunction, such as **a menos que**, that [ALWAYS] requires a subjunctive verb in the dependent clause."

1. ADVERB CLAUSE CONNECTORS of TIME: **INDICATIVE** or **SUBJUNCTIVE**

SUBORDINATE CONJUNCTIONS: **INDICATIVE/SUBJUNCTIVE** VERB IN DEPENDENT CLAUSE ?

What type of action is expressed in the main clause:

habitual action, future action, command, past action?

cuando	when	sent. 1, 5, 12, 20	(main clause expressed a habitual action - indicative)
cuando	when	sent. 18	(main clause expressed a future action - subjunctive)
despues de que	after	sent. 13	(main clause expressed a future action - subjunctive)
en cuanto	as soon as	sent. 15	(main clause expressed a future action - subjunctive)
hasta que	until	sent. 2, 23	(main clause expressed a future action - subjunctive)
tan pronto como	as soon as	sent. 6, 22	(main clause expressed a future action - subjunctive)

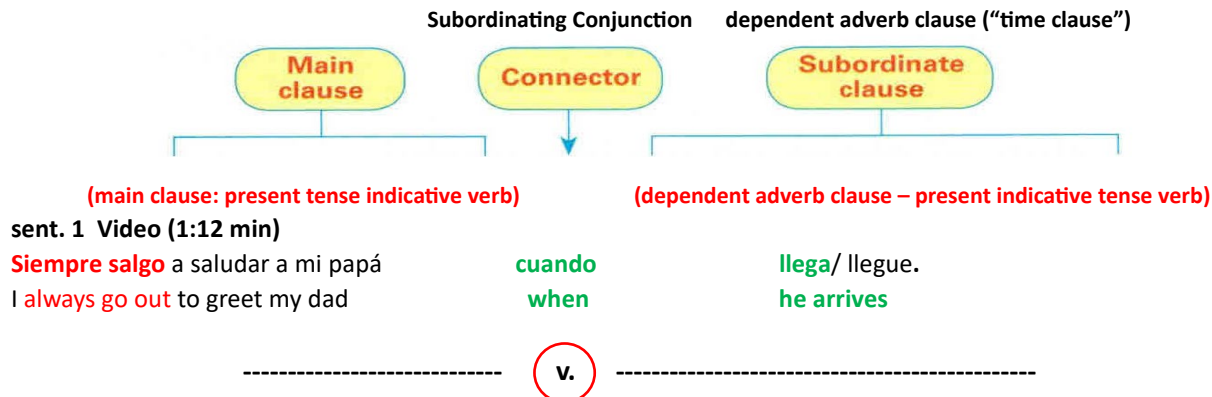
RULES: Vistas, p. 461, Tu Mundo, sec. 12.2, p. 420, NRGMS, sec. 20.4.7 – Subordinators of time, p. 268

1. “With the conjunctions above, use the subjunctive in the subordinate clause if the main (independent) clause expresses a **future action or command**.” Vistas, p. 461

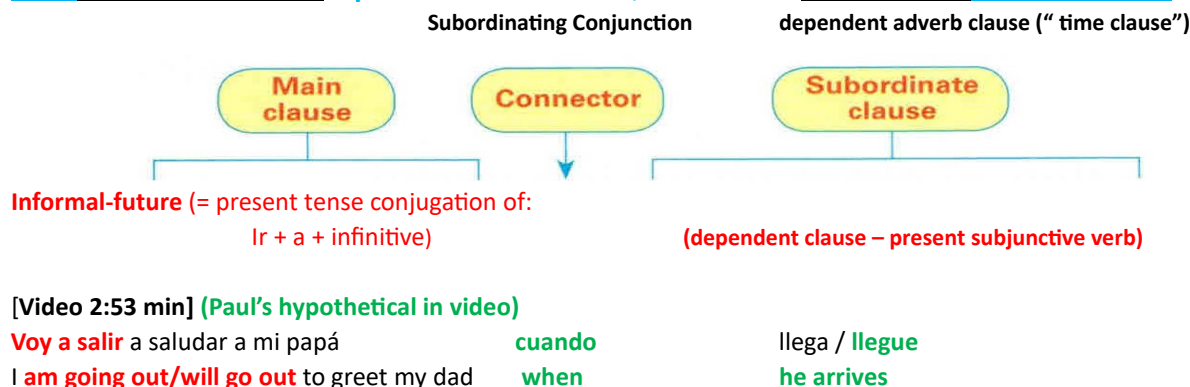
Informal-future (= present tense conjugation of Ir + a + infinitive) (“voy a salir”) (Vistas 4th ed., p. 126) , or **formal future** tense ending in: saldré (é, á, ás, á, emos, –, án) (Vistas 4th ed., p. 552)

2. “With the conjunctions above, the indicative is used in the subordinate clause if the verb in the main (independent) clause expresses an action that **habitually happens, or that happened in the past**.” Vistas, p. 461

Compare MAIN CLAUSE VERB expresses habitual action; DEPENDENT CLAUSE VERB IN INDICATIVE



With MAIN CLAUSE VERB expresses future action; DEPENDENT CLAUSE VERB IN SUBJUNCTIVE



2. ADVERB CLAUSE CONNECTORS of TIME: **ALWAYS REQUIRES SUBJUNCTIVE**

ALWAYS REQUIRES A SUBJUNCTIVE VERB IN THE DEPENDENT CLAUSE

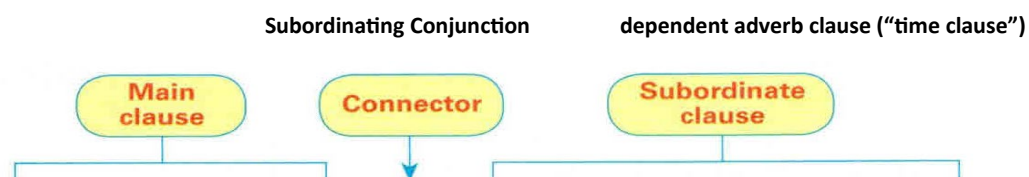
a menos que	unless	sent. 7 (ALWAYS Subjunctive verb)
antes (de) que	before	sent. 25 (ALWAYS Subjunctive verb)
con tal (de) que	provided that	[no worksheet example]
en caso (de) que ³	in case (that)	sent. 28 (ALWAYS Subjunctive verb)
para que	so that	[no worksheet example]
sin que	without	[no worksheet example]

RULES: Vistas, p. 460, Tu Mundo, sec. 12.2, p. 420, NRGMS, sec. 20.4.7 – Subordinators of time, p. 268

1. “With the conjunctions above, the subjunctive is used to express a **hypothetical situation, uncertainty as to whether an action or event will take place, or a condition that may or may not be fulfilled.**” Vistas, p. 460.
2. **The infinitive, not que + [subjunctive], is used after the prepositions antes de, para, and sin when there is no change of subject.”**
Compare Te llamamos **ante de salir** de la casa. [Indicative]. **We** will call you before **[we]** leaving the house. (same subject in main and dependent clauses)
With Te llamamos mañana **ante de que salgas**. [Subjunctive]. **We** will call you tomorrow before **you** leave the house. (different subjects in main and dependent clauses)” Vistas, p. 460.

ADVERB CLAUSE CONNECTORS of TIME ILLUSTRATIONS (con’t)

THAT **ALWAYS REQUIRE A SUBJUNCTIVE VERB IN THE DEPENDENT CLAUSE**



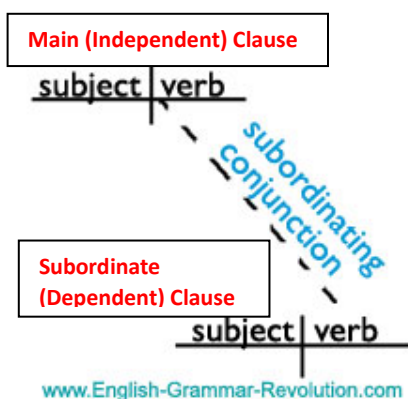
sent. 7 [Video 8:20]; see also sent. 25, 28

no sabré qué hacer I won't know what to do.	A menos que Unless	me avises, you let me know,
--	------------------------------	---------------------------------------

³ Paul's Video [20:33] Another way of saying “in case (that)” is “por si,” or “por si acaso”.

PARTIAL SENTENCE DIAGRAM (ADVERB CLAUSE)

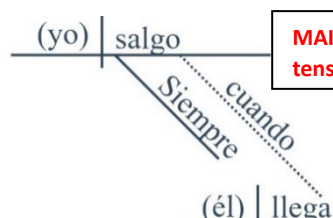
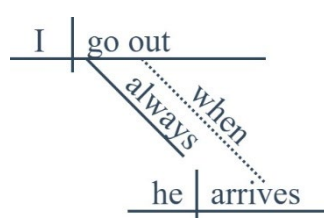
HOW THE SENTENCE-PARTS OF THE ADVERB CLAUSE ARE RELATED TO THE MAIN CLAUSE



I am a visual learner and the figures are sentence diagrams, which are pictures of sentences that show us how parts of a sentence are related. “You can see that [subordinating] conjunctions connect dependent clauses (also called subordinate clauses) to independent clauses just by looking at the sentence diagram! The subordinating conjunction goes on a dotted line between the two clauses. The top clause is an independent clause and the bottom clause is a dependent clause. **We call this kind of**

sentence a complex sentence.” <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/list-of-conjunctions.html>

SENTENCE 1: “I always go out to greet my dad when he arrives.” All the words in a dependent adverb clause of time (he arrives/llega) act as one part of speech, **an adverb**, to modify the verb “go out” / “salgo” in the independent clause. We place “cuando”⁴, the subordinate conjunction, on the slanted dotted line, to show it connects the verb, salgo, in the main clause to the verb, llega, in the dependent clause. Llega is in the indicative because of “always” – habitual action.



MAIN CLAUSE: The Main-Clause Verb (salgo) is in the present tense Indicative Mood.

SUBORDINATE (DEPENDENT) CLAUSE: The Adverb-Clause Verb (llega) is in the present tense Indicative Mood because it's habitual action (always).

⁴ **Compare:** A Relative Adverb (e.g., cuando) connects a relative [adjective] clause to the main clause: < La semana pasada, cuando volví de vacaciones, llovió sin parar. > The dependent adjective clause modifies the antecedent noun, “week”, in the main clause. <https://espanol.lingolia.com/en/grammar/adverbs/types>

with An Adverb-of-Time (e.g., cuando) (a/k/a subordinating conjunction) introduces an adverb clause of time. The adverb-of-time clause, connected by (cuando), modifies the verb in the main clause. < Sent. 1 - Siempre salgo a saludar a mi papá cuando llega.> <https://espanol.lingolia.com/en/grammar/adverbs/types>

ADJECTIVE CLAUSE (OVERVIEW) (also called a Relative Clause): An adjective modifies a noun or pronoun. “Because an adjective clause functions as an adjective, the whole clause is acting as one part of speech - an adjective. It can modify a noun or pronoun, which is known as the **antecedent**. The adjective clause gives more information about the noun or pronoun it modifies in the independent clause.”

https://www.123teachme.com/learn_spanish/dependent_clauses

1. **CONNECTOR (Relative Pronoun):** Relative pronouns: (a) “connect relative and main clauses, (b) can be subjects, direct objects, or objects of a preposition, (c) are required in Spanish, though they are sometimes optional in English “[Adjective] clauses are most frequently introduced by the relative pronouns: **que** (which/that/who), **quien/quienes** (who), **el que, la que, los que, los que** (which/that/who), or **el/la cual, los/las cuales** (which/that/who).”

SOURCES: <https://www.lawlessspanish.com/grammar/pronouns/relative-pronouns/>

https://www.123teachme.com/learn_spanish/dependent_clauses

<https://www.lawlessspanish.com/grammar/pronouns/relative-pronouns/>

Vistas, p. 415, 486; NRGMS, sec. 39.1.3 – English and Spanish relative clauses compared, p. 516.⁵

1. **CONNECTOR (Relative Adjective):** “Relative adjectives like **cuyo, cuya, cuyos, cuyas** (whose) provide additional information about something or someone (a noun) previously mentioned in a sentence (called the **antecedent**) and introduce a relative clause. **Cuyo** contrasts with [relative pronouns](#) because it agrees in number and gender with the **possessed noun**, not the **possessor**.”

SOURCES: <https://www.spanishdict.com/guide/relative-adjectives-like-cuyo-in-spanish>

2. **CONNECTOR (Relative Adverb):** “Relative adverbs connect a relative [adjective] clause to a main clause. Relative adverbs are almost identical to interrogative adverbs (question words), the difference is that relative adverbs do not take an accent.”
Relative adverbs: **donde, adonde** (where, in which or at which), **cuando**⁶ (when), and **como** (how), **cuanto** (whatever, as much as). For these to be relative adverbs, it's necessary to have an **antecedent (a noun)**.

SOURCES: <https://espanol.lingolia.com/en/grammar/adverbs/types>

⁵ Spanish relative pronouns/adverbs differ from English relative pronouns/adverbs. NRGMS, sec. 39.1.3 – English and Spanish relative clauses compared, p. 516. In English, “relative pronouns are: (who, whose, whom, that, which); relative adverbs (where, when, why).” <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/clauses.html>

⁶ **Compare:** A Relative Adverb (e.g., **cuando**) connects a relative [adjective] clause to the main clause: < La **semana** pasada, **cuando** volví de vacaciones, llovió sin parar. > The dependent adjective clause modifies the antecedent noun, “**week**”, in the main clause. <https://espanol.lingolia.com/en/grammar/adverbs/types>

with An Adverb-of-Time (e.g., **cuando**) (a/k/a subordinating conjunction) introduces an adverb clause of time. The adverb-of-time clause, connected by (cuando), modifies the verb in the main clause. < Sent. 1 - Siempre salgo a saludar a mi papá **cuando** llega.> <https://spanish.yabla.com/lesson-Using-Subjunctive-after-Conjunctions-of-Time-731>

ADJECTIVE CLAUSE CONNECTORS (**Relative Pronouns**)

RELATIVE PRONOUNS FOLLOWED BY INDICATIVE OR SUBJUNCTIVE VERB IN DEPENDENT CLAUSE Vistas, p.415

que	which/that/who
quien/quienes	who, whom, that
lo que	what, that which, or the thing that

RULES: (Relative Pronouns) SOURCES: Vistas, p. 415

1. **Que:** "Que is the most frequently used relative pronoun. It can refer to things or people. Unlike English, "that", "**que**" is never omitted in Spanish."
2. **Quien:** "The relative pronoun **quien** refers only to people, and is often used after a preposition or the personal **a**. It has two forms: **quien** and **quienes**."
3. **Lo que:** "Unlike **que** and **quien**, **lo que** refers to an idea, a situation, or a past event and means *what, that which, or the thing that*."

Other Relative pronouns used to introduce relative clauses SOURCES:

Groo Skool: Relative Pronouns & Prepositions in Spanish (el/la, los/que)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r04laDXcvTs>

el que ("the one that" or "who" for **masculine singular** nouns)

la que ("the one that" or "who" for **feminine singular** nouns)

los que ("the ones that" or "who" or "those" for **masculine plural or mixed** nouns)

las que ("the ones that" or "who" or "those" for **feminine plural** nouns)

Yabla.com: <https://spanish.yabla.com/lesson-Spanish-Relative-Pronouns-Part-1El-que-La-que-Los-que-Las-que-2373>

1. "**With or Without an antecedent.** *el que, la que, los que* and *las que* are relative pronouns used to introduce relative clauses. A relative pronoun, used in a relative clause, describes a person or thing. Each must agree in gender (**masculine or feminine**), and in number with its antecedent."
2. "**Antecedents** The noun to which the relative pronoun refers is known as an **antecedent** or **referent**. Be aware that while antecedents are sometimes mentioned explicitly in sentences containing the relative pronouns *el que, la que, los que* and *las que*; in other cases, the speaker understands what is being referenced based on the previous conversation."
3. "**With Prepositions:** *el que, la que, los que* or *las que* - ("which," "that," "when," "where," "who" or "whom") Note that when the relative pronouns *el que, los que, la que* and *las que* are preceded by prepositions, they can be translated with a vast array of terms such as "which," "that," "when," "where," "who" or "whom," depending upon what they refer to."

el que, la que, los que, los que	what/that/that which/who
el/la cual, los/las cuales	which/that/who "

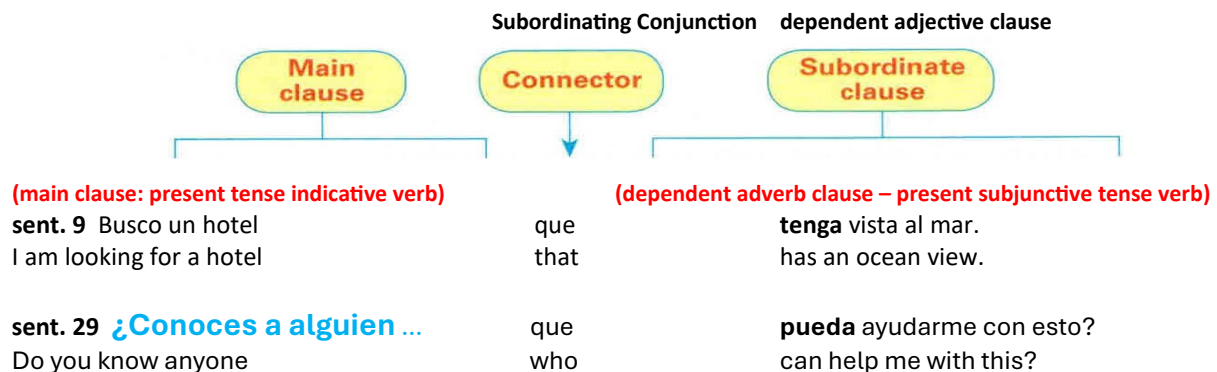
RULES: (Subjunctive or Indicative) Vistas, p.486

1. **Subjunctive:** "The subjunctive is used in an adjective (relative) clause that **refers to a person, place, thing or idea that either does not exist or whose existence is uncertain or indefinite.**"
2. **Subjunctive:** "The subjunctive is commonly used in questions with adjective (relative) clauses **when the speaker is trying to find out information about which he is uncertain.** If the person who responds to the question knows the information, use the indicative."
3. **Indicative:** "When the adjective(relative) clause **refers to a SPECIFIC person, place, thing or idea that is clearly known, certain, or definite,** the indicative is used."

sent. 9, 21 - **refers to a person, place, thing or idea that either does not exist or whose existence is uncertain or indefinite; un, una, unos, unas – a/an, indefinite articles.** Collins easy learning Spanish Grammar (3rd ed. 2016), p.58; Vistas, p.240

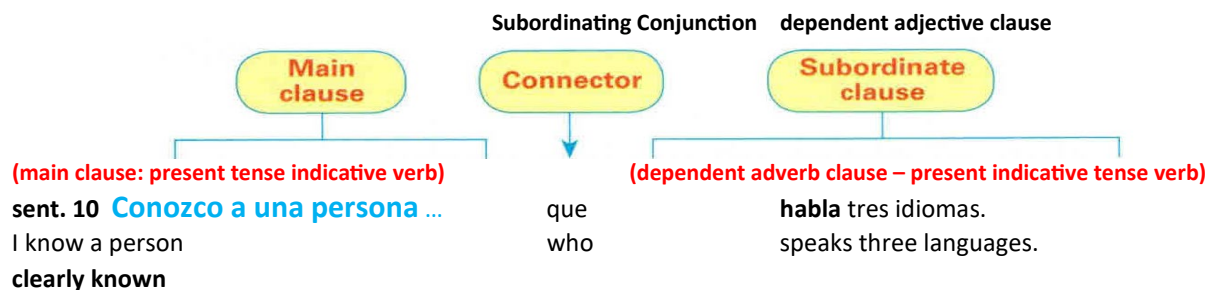
sent. 29 "a alguien" – **an indefinite pronoun meaning someone, somebody, anybody, anyone,** Collins easy learning Spanish Grammar (3rd ed. 2016), p.58; Vistas, p.240 acts

COMPARE Sent. 9, 21 NOTE: Words can act as more than 1 part of speech. Here "que" acts a relative pronoun. In the Noun Clause section below, "que" acts as a subordinating conjunction to connect the main and dependent clauses.



WITH Sent. 10

Sent. 10 - **refers to a SPECIFIC person, place, thing or idea that is clearly known, certain, or definite**



Antecedent "woman" = noun.
Nouns do noun jobs, one of which = subject in this Main (Independent) Clause

SENTENCE DIAGRAM (ADJECTIVE CLAUSE)

– Note the difference between the two "antecedents" as parts-of-a-sentence

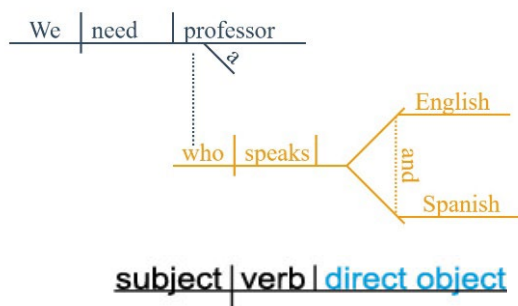
HOW THE SENTENCE-PARTS OF THE ADJECTIVE CLAUSE ARE RELATED TO THE MAIN CLAUSE



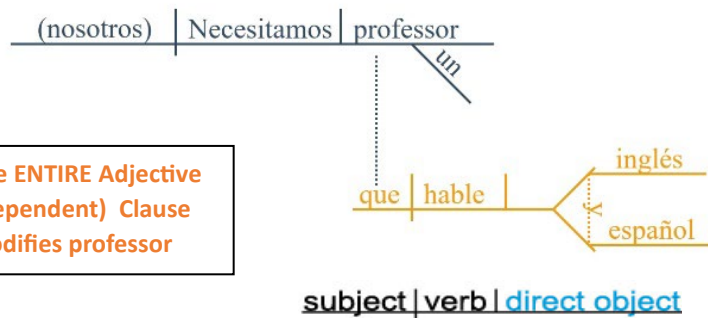
The ENTIRE Adjective (Dependent) Clause, modifies woman

I am a visual learner and the figures are sentence diagrams, which are pictures of sentences that show us how parts of a sentence are related. You can see that the relative pronoun (that/who/which) connects the dependent clause (also called adjective (Dependent) clause) to the Independent clause just by looking at the sentence diagram! We place "that/ who/which", the relative pronoun, on the subject line of the dependent clause and connect the dotted line from "who" to the antecedent, the noun "woman" in the main clause. This shows the ENTIRE adjective dependent clause modifies the antecedent (the noun, woman) in the main clause. **We call this kind of sentence a complex sentence.**

Sent. 21 - Antecedent "professor" = noun. Nouns do noun jobs, one of which = direct object in this Main (Independent) Clause



The ENTIRE Adjective (Dependent) Clause modifies professor



SENTENCE 21: All the words in the dependent adjective clause ("who speaks English and Spanish") act as one part of speech, **an adjective**, which modifies the antecedent (the noun, professor) in the (main) independent clause. We place "que/ who", the relative pronoun on the subject line of the dependent clause. Then we connect the dotted line from it to the noun in the main clause. This shows the ENTIRE adjective clause modifies the antecedent, noun professor, in the main clause.⁷ **See also** sent. 9, 10, 29

⁷ "English" and "Spanish" are compound direct objects connected by the coordinating conjunction "and." Eugene Moutoux, Drawing Sentences (2016), p. 41. O'Brien, Get Smart Lesson 13, p.26

NOUN CLAUSE (OVERVIEW): “Nouns are one of the main parts of speech⁸ in English and Spanish. [Don’t confuse parts-of-speech with parts-of-a-sentence⁹]. Nouns are called *sustantivos* in Spanish and can be a person, place, thing, or idea. They usually appear as the subject (the thing or person doing the action) at the beginning of a sentence or as an object (the thing or person affected by the verb) at the end.

A noun clause is a clause that functions as a noun [and do noun jobs¹⁰]. In Spanish, you call them *cláusulas nominales* or *cláusulas sustantivas*. Just as nouns can appear in a sentence as subjects or objects, the same applies to noun clauses.” [Although] “a noun clause can work as a subject of the main clause, [it] is more [common] to see a noun clause that works as an object and is usually introduced by the conjunction *que* (that).” SOURCES: <https://www.spanish.academy/blog/everything-you-need-to-know-about-the-noun-clause-in-spanish/>

RULES: (Subjunctive or Indicative)

“SUBJUNCTIVE? Must satisfy 2 rules:

1. RULE #1: Subject 1 must be different from Subject 2: I want my daughter to have more money. Main clause Subject 1: “I” Dependent Clause Subject 2: “daughter”
2. Rule # 2: The verb in the main clause needs to be a WEIRDO verb (Wishes, Emotions, Impersonal expressions, Requests/Recommendations, Doubt/Disbelief/Denial, Ojalá)”
3. NOTE: Ojalá is ALWAYS followed by the subjunctive. Vistas, p. 453

INDICATIVE?

1. When the subject is the same, use the infinitive. “I want to have more money.”
2. Even if there are two different subjects, when the main verb is not a WEIRDO verb use the indicative.”

SOURCE: <https://www.spanish.academy/blog/everything-you-need-to-know-about-the-noun-clause-in-spanish/>

⁸ English Parts of Speech: <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/parts-of-speech.html>
Spanish Parts of Speech: <https://www.tellmeinspanish.com/grammar/parts-of-speech-in-spanish/>
“Many words can function as more than one part of speech.” <https://www.english-grammar-revolution.com/what-part-of-speech.html> (e.g., *que* functions as a relative pronoun in adjective clause, but *que* functions as a conjunction in a noun clause).

⁹ There are many parts of a sentence but the three “[basic parts of a sentence](#)” are the subject, the verb, and (often, but not always) the object. The subject is usually a noun — a word that names a person, place, or thing. The verb (or predicate) usually follows the subject and identifies an action or a state of being. An object receives the action and usually follows the verb.” Nordquist, Richard. “Sentence Parts and Sentence Structures.” ThoughtCo, Apr. 5, 2023, [thoughtco.com/sentence-parts-and-sentence-structures-1689671](https://www.thoughtco.com/sentence-parts-and-sentence-structures-1689671).

¹⁰ “Noun clauses [do noun jobs so they] can function as subjects, direct objects, predicate nominatives, appositives, objects of preposition, and adverbial objectives.” “An adverbial objective is a noun that acts like an adverb.” Eugene Moutoux, *Drawing Sentences* (2016), pp.75, 42.

(Emotion) sent. 14, 16, 24 **NOUN CLAUSE acts as SUBJECT**

	Main clause	Connector	Subordinate clause
sent. 14	Me molesta It bothers me	que that	no pongas atención en clase. you don't pay attention in class
sent. 16	Me preocupa I am worried	que that	mi hijo esté enfermo. my son is sick.
sent. 24	Me sorprende It surprises me	que that	quieran mudarse tan pronto. they want to move so soon.

COMPARE (Doubt/Disbelief/Denial) sent. 3, 19 **NOUN CLAUSE acts as DIRECT OBJECT**

	Main clause	Connector	Subordinate clause
sent. 3	No creo I don't think	que -- ¹¹	ella tenga razón. she is right.
sent. 19	No pienso I do not think	que ---	esto sea una buena idea. this is a good idea.

		v.	
	Main clause	Connector	Subordinate clause

WITH (CERTAINTY) sent. 4, 8, 11, 17, 26 **NOUN CLAUSE acts as DIRECT OBJECT**

sent. 8	Creo I think	que --	este restaurante es el mejor de la ciudad. this restaurant is the best in the city.
sent. 11	No dudo I do not doubt	que that	ellos trabajan mucho. they work a lot.

¹¹ "The main difference is that in English it is common to omit "that," while *que* is nearly always mandatory." Erichsen, Gerald. "Using the Spanish 'Que' as a Conjunction." ThoughtCo, Apr. 5, 2023, [thoughtco.com/using-que-as-a-conjunction-3079177](https://www.thoughtco.com/using-que-as-a-conjunction-3079177).

SENTENCE DIAGRAM (NOUN CLAUSE ACTING AS DIRECT OBJECT)

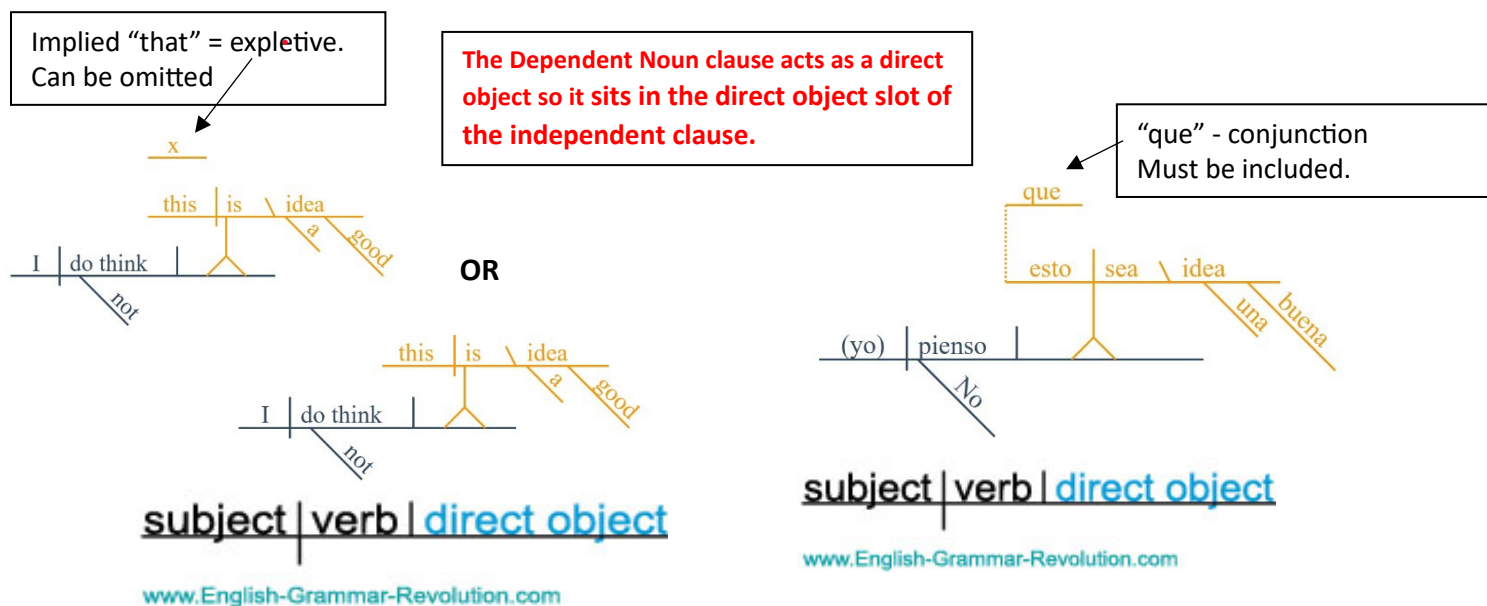
THE DEPENDENT NOUN CLAUSE DOES NOUN JOBS IN THE MAIN CLAUSE

I am a visual learner and the figures are sentence diagrams, which are pictures of sentences that show us how parts of a sentence are related. The Spanish noun clause (“que esto sea una buena idea”) is introduced by the conjunction “que”, which cannot be omitted in Spanish

That – Expressed: In English grammar, except to introduce the noun clause (“Noun-Clause Marker”), “that” has no meaning, so it is called an “**expletive**.” Expletives are diagrammed on “skyhooks,” which are lines that float above the noun clauses. O’Brien, Sentence Diagramming Reference Manual, p.38. “The pedestal holding the noun clause is sitting in the direct object slot of the independent clause.” Id. at 54. If the noun clause were doing the noun job, subject, the pedestal would sit in the subject slot of the independent clause. We call this kind of sentence a complex sentence. **That – Implied:** In English, “[w]hen a *that*-clause functions as a direct object, ... the expletive “*that*” is often omitted. When this happens, an x is placed on the line otherwise occupied by *that*. Eugene Moutoux, Drawing Sentences (2016), p.99. See also Moutoux, Sentence 44 <https://www.german-latin-english.com/basicdiagrams41-45.htm> . **Some grammar instructors omit the skyhook and X altogether.**

In Spanish, “que” is a necessary part of speech, a conjunction, and not merely a Noun-Clause Marker or introductory word, as in the English “that.”

sent. 19 No pienso que esto sea una buena idea.
I do not think --- this is a good idea.



See also (doubt, disbelief, denial) sent. 3, 19 and (certainty) sent. 4, 8, 11, 17, 26

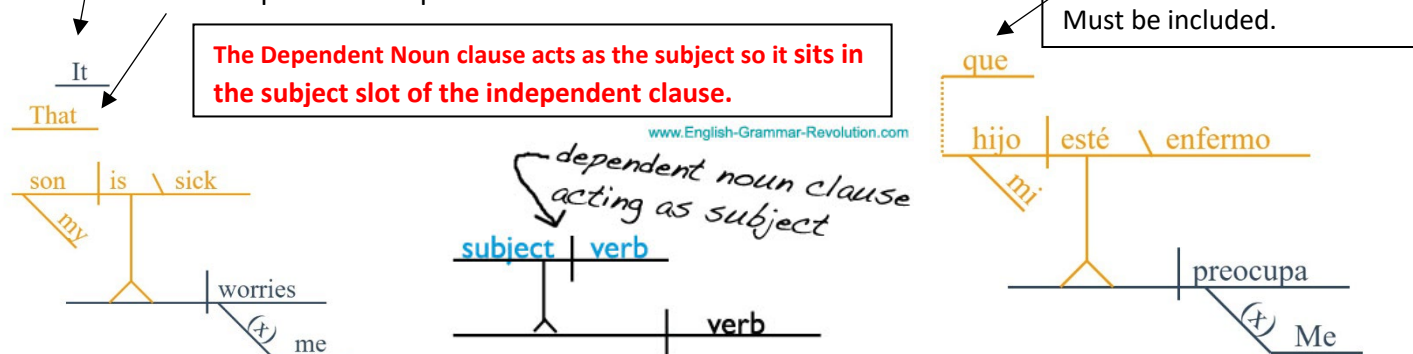
SENTENCE DIAGRAM (NOUN CLAUSE ACTING AS SUBJECT)

THE DEPENDENT NOUN CLAUSE DOES NOUN JOBS IN THE MAIN CLAUSE

sent. 16 Me preocupa que mi hijo esté enfermo See also (Emotion) sent. 14, 16, 24
I am¹² worried that my son is sick. [It worries me that my son is sick.]

It = expletive in main clause.

That = expletive in dependent clause



¹² Note: I was confused when the Worksheet translated sent. 16 Me preocupa... to: "I am worried," not "It worries me..." [The Worksheet translates sent. 14 "Me molesta" as "It bothers me..." and sent. 24 "Me sorprende" as: "It surprises me..."] I was sure the clause in sent. 16 was a Subject- Noun Clause. But in the English translation, it looked like a Direct-Object Noun Clause. LanguaTalk clarified:

"Let's break it down step by step.

1. ****Objeto indirecto (Indirect object):**** In the sentence 16 - "Me preocupa que mi hijo esté enfermo," the indirect object is ****"me"**. It shows who is affected by the action of the verb "preocupa" (who is worried). In this case, "me" refers to "I" (the person feeling worried).**
2. ****Cláusula de nombre (Noun clause):**** **The noun clause is ****"que mi hijo esté enfermo."**** It acts as the subject of the verb "preocupa."** This clause answers the question ***what worries me?*** (The fact that my son is sick worries me).
3. ****Traducción al inglés (Translation):**** The sentence translates to: ****"It worries me that my son is sick."**** Notice how the noun clause in Spanish is introduced by "que," and in English, it becomes "that."

In Spanish, the verb ****"preocupar"**. is a ****backward verb**** (like "gustar"). This means the subject of the sentence is the thing causing the worry, while the person who feels worried is indicated by an indirect object pronoun (like "me," "te," "le," etc.). - ****Me preocupa que mi hijo esté enfermo.**** Translation: ****"It worries me that my son is sick."******

In English, [although] we usually say "I am worried" instead of "It worries me." the focus [in English] shifts to ***your emotional state***, rather than the cause of it [as it would in Spanish]. English places the subject-noun-clause at the end of the sentence for clarity and flow. Both are grammatically correct [in English], but are slightly different in structure and emphasis in Spanish.

In simpler terms, verbs like ****"sorprender,"**** ****"molestar,"**** and ****"preocupar"**. naturally emphasize the external cause of the emotion, not your internal state. When translating into English, we sometimes adapt them to sound more natural by saying "I am worried," "I am surprised" or "I am bothered," but the structure and nuance in Spanish are not identical." (Transcript 3/17/2025 Lydia Brandt and LanguaTalk).**

SUBJUNCTIVE WEIRDO CONJUGATION PRACTICE

WEIRDO VERB LISTS & WEIRDO CONJUGATION DRILLS:

Click on any particular category

WISHES:

<https://www.spanishdict.com/guide/expressing-wishes-and-desires-with-the-subjunctive>

EMOTION:

<https://www.spanishdict.com/guide/expressing-emotions-with-the-subjunctive>

IMPERSONAL EXPRESSIONS:

<https://www.spanishdict.com/guide/expressing-emotions-with-the-subjunctive>

RECOMMENDATIONS AND REQUESTS:

<https://www.spanishdict.com/guide/expressing-recommendations-and-requests-with-the-subjunctive>

DOUBT, DISBELIEF, DENIAL:

<https://www.spanishdict.com/guide/expressing-doubt-and-denial-with-the-subjunctive>

OJALA:

<https://www.spanishdict.com/guide/using-ojala-with-the-subjunctive>